Alex Mateescu

IT Service Engineer | Infrastructure, Identity and Security
Leigh, Greater Manchester | al3ksmatee@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/al3ksmatee | hawkode.github.io

PROFILE

IT engineer supporting a hybrid Microsoft environment across two UK sites: Active Directory on Windows Server 2022, Microsoft Entra ID synced through Entra Connect, Microsoft 365 and Exchange Online. Handles identity lifecycle, endpoint patching, vulnerability remediation and the technical side of Cyber Essentials. Outside work, builds home labs that attack Windows hosts and detect the same activity in Splunk. Working towards an Infrastructure Security Engineer role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Identity and Access:** Active Directory Domain Services (AD DS), Group Policy (GPO), Microsoft Entra ID, Microsoft Entra Connect, hybrid identity, multi-factor authentication (MFA), access reviews, Bitwarden
- **Infrastructure and Cloud:** Windows Server 2022, VMware ESXi virtualisation, DNS, DHCP, file shares and NTFS permissions, Microsoft 365, Exchange Online, Microsoft Azure, SPF, DKIM, DMARC
- **Networking:** VLAN segmentation, TCP/IP, Wi-Fi, Windows Defender Firewall, WireGuard VPN, remote access
- **Security Operations:** vulnerability management (Qualys, OpenVAS), patch management, Windows hardening, endpoint detection and response (EDR), SIEM (Splunk, SPL), Sysmon, Windows event logs, MITRE ATT&CK, Nmap, Cyber Essentials
- **Endpoint and Automation:** Windows 11, ManageEngine Endpoint Central, ManageEngine ADManager Plus, PowerShell, Robocopy, Snipe-IT, IT asset management, SOPs and technical documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Service Engineer (Systems Engineer scope) | Swagelok Central, Manchester, UK | Jul 2025 – Present

- Manage joiners, movers and leavers in Active Directory and Microsoft Entra ID for 100+ users: group membership, licences and MFA enrolment.
- Built GPOs that deploy the Qualys Cloud Agent, EDR and ManageEngine agents, so domain-joined devices install all three automatically and repair any that fail a health check.
- Patch 125 Windows endpoints through ManageEngine Endpoint Central and report compliance against agreed timescales.
- Take VMware ESXi snapshots of server VMs before patching or configuration changes, keeping a rollback point if an update fails.
- Triage Qualys scan findings by severity, apply fixes and rescan to confirm closure.
- Implemented the technical controls for the company's 2025 Cyber Essentials certification, covering access reviews, endpoint policy changes, patch timescales and supporting SOPs.
- Resolve 1st and 2nd line support issues across Microsoft 365, DNS, DHCP, VLANs, Wi-Fi and remote access.
- Set up Snipe-IT as the asset register for both sites, and traced patch panel ports to their wall sockets, labelling them and recording the mapping.

Key project: Bristol and Manchester domain consolidation

- Merged two site domains into a single Active Directory domain with a Windows Server 2022 domain controller VM on VMware ESXi in each office (AD DS, DNS, DHCP), then redesigned the OU structure and verified replication between them.
- Migrated 60+ accounts with ADManager Plus and matched each to its existing Entra ID identity, leaving staff with one synced password for Windows and Microsoft 365.
- Moved file shares with Robocopy, keeping NTFS permissions, and replaced manual domain joins with a ManageEngine-deployed PowerShell script that placed Windows 11 laptops in their correct OUs.

Shipping Auditor | Amazon, UK | Sep 2018 – Sep 2024

- Audited outbound shipment data and raised discrepancies for correction.
- Worked with IT and operations staff to diagnose faults on handheld scanners and warehouse systems, and trained new associates to use them.

IT Technician | DUEPUNTOZERO, Italy | Jan 2017 – Aug 2018

- Assembled and deployed Windows desktops from bare hardware: BIOS settings, OS installation, drivers and peripherals.
- Fixed hardware, software, user profile and performance problems for end users.
- Configured user accounts, IP addressing, DNS and LAN connections.

PROJECTS

Write-ups with sanitised configs and searches at hawkode.github.io

Windows Privilege Escalation: Attack, Detect, Harden

- Escalated from a low-privilege foothold to SYSTEM on a Windows lab VM through credential harvesting, service misconfigurations, token abuse (SeImpersonatePrivilege) and SAM/SYSTEM hive theft.
- Recorded the Security log and Sysmon events each technique leaves, then wrote the hardening change that removes it.

Detecting Privilege Escalation in Splunk

- Sent Sysmon and command-line process auditing (Event ID 4688) from a Windows host to Splunk through a Universal Forwarder.
- Wrote SPL searches and scheduled alerts for named-pipe impersonation, hive theft, rogue services and MSI abuse, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK T1134, T1003.002, T1543.003 and T1548.

Segmented Home Network on UniFi Dream Router 7

- Designed four VLANs with zone-based firewall rules, content filtering and forced DNS for the children's VLAN, and an isolated guest network behind a captive portal.
- Added WireGuard remote access with no inbound services exposed, and dual-stack IPv6 with a /64 per VLAN.

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA Security+, Network+ and A+ (Secure Infrastructure Specialist)
- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900)

In progress

- TryHackMe Pre Security (SEC0), target Dec 2026
- TryHackMe Cyber Security 101 (SEC1), target Dec 2026
- CompTIA Cybersecurity Analyst (CySA+), target 2027
- Microsoft Certified: Security Operations Analyst Associate (SC-200), target 2027
- Microsoft Certified: Identity and Access Administrator Associate (SC-300), target 2027

EDUCATION

- BSc (Hons) Computer Science | Arden University | 2024 – 2025
- HND Digital Technology | GBS | 2021 – 2023